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Education

2024 – present **Ph.D. Student**, Psychological Sciences

University of Missouri
Columbia, Missouri, United States
Advisor: Nicholas Gaspelin

2021 – 2024 **M.S.**, Experimental Psychology

Guangzhou University
Guangzhou, China
Advisor: Shimin Fu

2014 – 2018 **B.S.**, Human Resource Management

Wuhan Textile University
Wuhan, China

Peer-Reviewed Publications

*Author order reflects contribution. * These authors contributed equally to this research.*

- (8) **Zhang, Y.**, & Gaspelin, N. (2026). Learned Suppression of Salient Distractors is Rapid and Highly Flexible. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition*.
- (7) **Zhang, Y.**, & Gaspelin, N. (2026). From capture to control: Initial Capture Increases Learned Suppression. *Psychological Science*, 37(4), 227-242.
- (6) **Zhang, Y.**, Zhang, H., & Fu, S. (2024). Relative saliency affects attentional capture and suppression of color and face singleton distractors: Evidence from event-related potential studies. *Cerebral Cortex*, 34(4), bhae176.
- (5) **Zhang, Y.**, & Gaspelin, N. (2024). Saliency effects on attention are enabled by task relevance. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance*, 50(11), 1131-1142.
- (4) Pang, C*, Chen, Y*, **Zhang, Y***, Nan, W., Fu, S. (2024). Suppression on the basis of template for rejection is reactive: Evidence from human electrophysiology. *Attention, Perception, & Psychophysics*, 86, 1148–1162.
- (3) **Zhang, Y.**, (2023). Attentional Suppression of Salient Distractors in Visual Search: Proactive or Reactive? *Advances in Psychology*, 13(9), 3726-3732.
- (2) Chen, X., Xu, B., Chen, Y., Zeng, X., **Zhang, Y.**, & Fu, S. (2023). Saliency affects attentional capture and suppression of abrupt-onset and color singleton distractors: Evidence from event-related potential studies. *Psychophysiology*, 60(8), e14 290.
- (1) Zeng, X., Ji, L., Liu, Y., **Zhang, Y.**, & Fu, S. (2022). Visual mismatch negativity reflects enhanced response to the deviant: Evidence from event-related potentials and electroencephalogram time-frequency analysis. *Frontiers in Human Neuroscience*, 16, 800 855.

Manuscripts – In Prep or Under Review

- (1) **Zhang, Y.**, Luck, S. J., & Gaspelin, N. (Under Review). Initial Capture as a Learning Signal for Attentional Suppression. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*

Conference Presentations

- (6) **Zhang, Y.**, & Gaspelin, N. (2026, May). *Initial Capture Increases Learned Suppression*. **Talk** presented at the Annual Meeting of Show-Me Mental State Conference, Missouri, MO.
- (5) **Zhang, Y.**, & Gaspelin, N. (2025, November). *Attentional Capture is Necessary to Initiate Learned Suppression*. **Talk** presented at the Annual Meeting of Psychonomic Society Annual Meeting, Denver, CO.
- (4) **Zhang, Y.**, & Gaspelin, N. (2025, May). *From Capture to Control: Initial Capture Leads to Learned Suppression*. **Poster** presents at the Annual Meeting of Vision Sciences, St. Petersburg, FL.
- (3) **Zhang, Y.**, & Gaspelin, N. (2024, November). *Saliency Effects on Attention Are Enabled by Task Relevance*. **Poster** Presented at Annual Meeting of Psychonomic Society, New York City, NY.
- (2) **Zhang, Y.**, Zhang, H., & Fu, S. (2024, October). *Relative saliency affects attentional capture and suppression of color and face singleton distractors: Evidence from event-related potential studies*. **Poster** presented at the National Academic Conference of Psychology, Chengdu, Sichuan Province, China.
- (1) **Zhang, Y.**, & Fu, S. (2023, April). *Task Difficulty Modulates the Effects of Relative Saliency on Attentional Capture and Suppression: An ERP Study*. **Poster** presented at the Academic Annual Conference of Psychology, Jinhua, Zhejiang Province, China.

Research Experience

2023 – present	Graduate Researcher, Attention & Distraction Lab (PI: Nicholas Gaspelin), University of Missouri
	- Led independent research projects on attention, resulting in first-author publications - Designed and programmed eye-tracking experiments using MATLAB and R - Presented work at national conferences as talks and posters - Mentored undergraduate researchers supporting data collection and preprocessing
2021 – 2024	Graduate Researcher, Brain & Cognitive Sciences Lab (PI: Shimin Fu), Guangzhou University
	- Conducted independent research projects on attention, resulting in first-author publications - Designed and programmed EEG experiments using E-Prime and R - Presented work at national conferences as posters - Assisted in supervising undergraduate students involved in data collection and lab tasks

Honors & Awards

2026	J. Frank Yates Student Travel Award, \$1000, Psychonomic Society
2026	Josephine Mitchell Smith Summer Fellowship, \$2200, University of Missouri
2024	Outstanding Graduate Award, Guangzhou University
2024	Excellent Master's Thesis Award, Guangzhou University
2023	First Prize, Learning Scholarship, Guangzhou University
2022	Third Prize, Learning Scholarship, Guangzhou University
2021	Third Prize, Learning Scholarship, Guangzhou University

Ad Hoc Journal Reviews

Ten ad hoc reviews in journals such as:

Attention, Perception, & Psychophysics | Journal of Experimental Psychology: Learning, Memory, and Cognition | Psychological Research | Experimental Brain Research

Undergraduate Research Mentoring

2024–2025 Tragan Chambers, McNair Research Scholar, University of Missouri

Role: Mentored Tragan Chambers on a McNair Research Project through the full project cycle: research question development, MATLAB programming, data collection, preprocessing and data analysis. Also provided feedback on final project writing, poster and oral presentation.

2023 – 2024 Hai Zhang, Graduation Project, Guangzhou University

Role: Mentored Hai Zhang on the development and completion of the graduation project, including research design, data collection, and analysis. Provided feedback on project writing and presentation to help the student successfully complete the program requirements.

Research Skills

- EEG/ERPs
- Eye-tracking
- MATLAB/Psychtoolbox programming;
- Advanced statistical modeling (R, Bayesian approaches)